JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Engineer with 6 years of hands-on experience building scalable data infrastructure and backend systems. I've spent the last few years moving between Glasgow and Edinburgh, working across fintech and enterprise software. I'm comfortable diving into legacy codebases, optimizing database queries, or designing new microservices from scratch. I've led small teams through complex migrations and enjoy mentoring junior engineers through their first challenging technical problems.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

Glasgow, United Kingdom

www.synapsedata.io

March 2022 - Present

Architected data pipeline infrastructure handling 2TB+ daily ingestion across 15+ source systems, reducing ETL latency by 60% through optimized Spark jobs and Delta Lake implementations

Led migration of monolithic API to microservices architecture using Go and gRPC, improving response times by 40% and enabling independent team deployments

Mentored 4 junior engineers on system design principles, code review practices, and incident response procedures during rapid team expansion

Implemented dbt transformations for analytics layer, establishing data governance standards and reducing reporting query times from 45 minutes to under 5 minutes

Senior Backend Engineer

Baillie Gifford Investment Managers

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

www.bailliegifford.com

July 2019 - February 2022

Designed and deployed real-time portfolio valuation engine in Python and Rust, processing 50,000+ securities daily with sub-second latency requirements

Implemented GPT-4 API integration for automated compliance report generation, reducing manual review time by 70% and improving consistency across regulatory documents

Rebuilt authentication and authorization system using OAuth2 and JWT tokens, eliminating security vulnerabilities identified in external audit and supporting single sign-on across 12 internal applications

Established observability framework using Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK stack, enabling proactive identification of performance issues and reducing mean time to resolution by 55%

Backend Developer

DataFlow Systems Ltd

Glasgow, United Kingdom

May 2017 - June 2019

Developed RESTful APIs in Java and Python supporting customer-facing web applications serving 500,000+ monthly active users

Optimized PostgreSQL queries and implemented Redis caching layer, reducing database load by 45% and improving API response times to meet SLA targets

Managed AWS infrastructure including EC2, RDS, and S3, implementing Infrastructure as Code practices with CloudFormation templates for repeatable deployments

Participated in on-call rotation and resolved production incidents affecting customer operations, establishing post-incident review process that reduced repeat occurrences by 40%

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science

University of Glasgow

Glasgow, United Kingdom

2013 - 2017

Grade: 2:1

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, Rust, Scala

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Cassandra, Delta Lake

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, CloudFormation), Google Cloud Platform

Data Technologies: Apache Spark, Airflow, Kafka, Parquet, Avro

DevOps and Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD, Prometheus, Grafana

API Design: REST, gRPC, OpenAPI/Swagger

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Other: CI/CD pipelines, Linux administration, distributed systems design, performance optimization